AEP FROM ZERO • PART 4 • MULTIPLY THE TEAM (AI)

EPISODE 37

AEP, AJO and CJA Interview Questions & Answers

AEP interview questions and answers, with Adobe Journey Optimizer (AJO) and Customer Journey Analytics (CJA) interview questions, answered from one real end-to-end build. Learn the answer pattern senior candidates use (claim, example, trade-off, verification) for Real-Time CDP vs AEP, identity resolution, ingestion failures, journeys vs campaigns, CJA vs Adobe Analytics and governing AI-assisted work. You will also turn failures into war stories, write five evidence-backed resume bullets

Free course on iTV • Surge Software Solutions, Bengaluru • Bloom is fictional

Previously: Demo Day, then a phone call

- Last time: Bloom in seven minutes, through Priya
- A stalled screen, a calm switch to screenshots
- The feared question, answered with a trade-off
- Today: a mock interview on AEP, AJO, CJA and AI
- Goal: answer every question from the Bloom build

KEY IDEA

Kavya presented Bloom's build in seven minutes and handled the panel. Then a recruiter called, and Vikram offered to play the hiring panel.

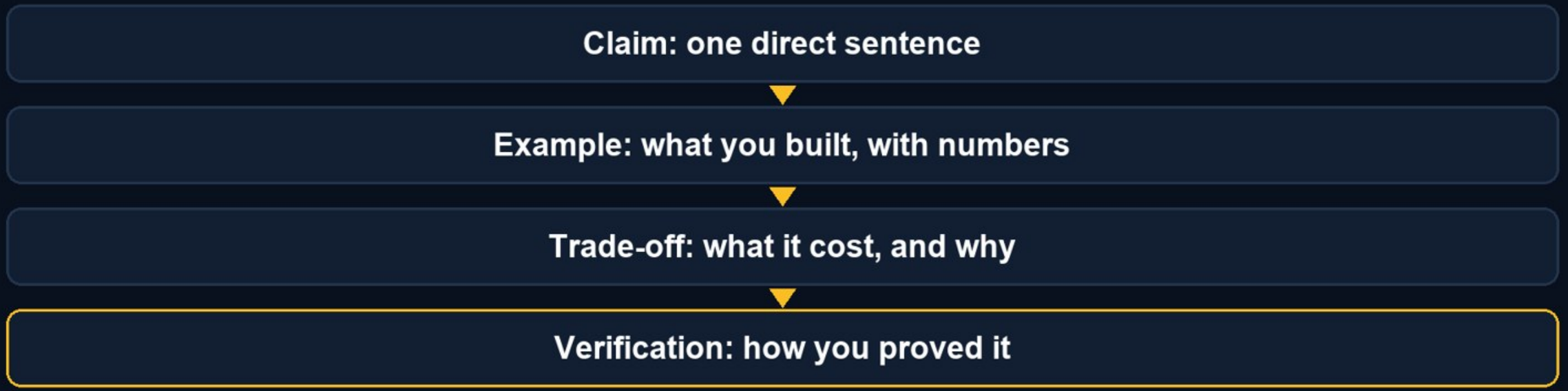
The mock panel: what is really being marked

- Is the business measurably better off?
- Can you explain and defend your decisions?
- Would you be safe in front of a client?
- Coverage is not the goal. Judgement is.
- Four rounds: AEP, AJO, CJA, then AI

KEY IDEA

Panels rarely mark feature coverage. They mark judgement: is the business better off, can you defend your decisions, and are you safe with a client?

Claim, example, trade-off, verification



KEY IDEA

Every strong answer has four parts: a one-sentence claim, an example you built, the trade-off you made, and how you verified it.

AEP round: Real-Time CDP and schema design

Question	Answer from the build
AEP or Real-Time CDP?	Same software, a commercial name
Why are orders events?	Written once, never changed
Why is tier on the profile?	It changes in place
How do you know?	Schemas, Browse: Enabled for Profile

KEY IDEA

Real-Time CDP is the commercial name for AEP's profile, audience and activation capabilities. Orders are events; loyalty tier is profile.

Most asked AEP question: your identity design

7:44 PM phone: ECID only, anonymous

▼

Sign-in: ECID and email together

▼

7:52 PM laptop order: email, BloomID

▼

One profile, three identities

▼

Trade-off: BloomID only via orders

▼

Proof: same person by email or BloomID

KEY IDEA

“Walk me through your identity design” is the most common senior AEP question. Answer with one customer, three identities and one sign-in.

Failure questions: zero rows, empty profile

Story	Evidence	Fix
0 of 500 rows ingested	3 rejected, 7 errors logged	Partial ingestion at 5%
Records failed: 7	Dataset row count: 497	Count rows, not errors
Priya not found	Records in Profile blank	Re-ingest, then escalate

KEY IDEA

Tell failures as evidence: three bad rows that threw away 497 good orders, and a profile store that stayed empty while everything looked green.

Merge policies, evaluation and governance

Question	Bloom answer
Dallas or Austin?	Merge policy decides; an owner signs
Batch or streaming?	Streaming for 2 of 5; within minutes
Consent?	In the rule: Ananya never enters
A restricted phone?	C2 label plus an enabled policy

KEY IDEA

The merge policy is a business decision. Choose streaming only when a journey must react within minutes. Consent and policies live in the platform.

AJO round: journeys vs campaigns vs decisioning

Tool	Answers	Bloom example
Campaign	What do we send?	Bloom Gold Thank-You
Journey	What happens next?	Bloom Welcome v1
Journey	Event, wait, exit	Cart Rescue v1
Decisioning	Which offer, for whom?	Comeback or Early Access

KEY IDEA

A campaign answers what do we send. A journey answers what happens to this customer next. Decisioning picks the offer inside the message.

AJO round: testing, triage and capping

- Real inboxes: Test mode, Simulation, Send proof
- Dry run contacts nobody and counts every path
- Triage: entry, qualification, wait, action, delivery
- No action row: no message was ever attempted
- Capping per journey is not frequency capping
- A Draft rule set protects nobody

KEY IDEA

Know which test options reach real inboxes, triage a silent journey with step events in order, and cap per person where it covers every marketing message.

CJA round: Adobe Analytics vs CJA in a minute

Word	One example
Person-based	Phone visit, laptop order: one person
Dataset-based	Journey data beside orders and profiles
Retroactive	Lowercase fix: 150 and 30 became 180
The honest part	Rebuild segments; no Activity Map

KEY IDEA

CJA is person-based, dataset-based and retroactive. Give one example for each word, then say honestly what does not come across.

CJA round: attribution honesty and the loop

- Attribution: a range per channel, model named
- Cart Rescue: 11.8% vs 7.9% holdout, soft
- Fallout: the leak at mobile checkout
- Checkout Leakers - Mobile feeds Checkout Rescue
- Expected effect and baseline, written first

KEY IDEA

Name the model and the window every time, call soft numbers soft, and prove the loop closed by showing the next campaign that changed.

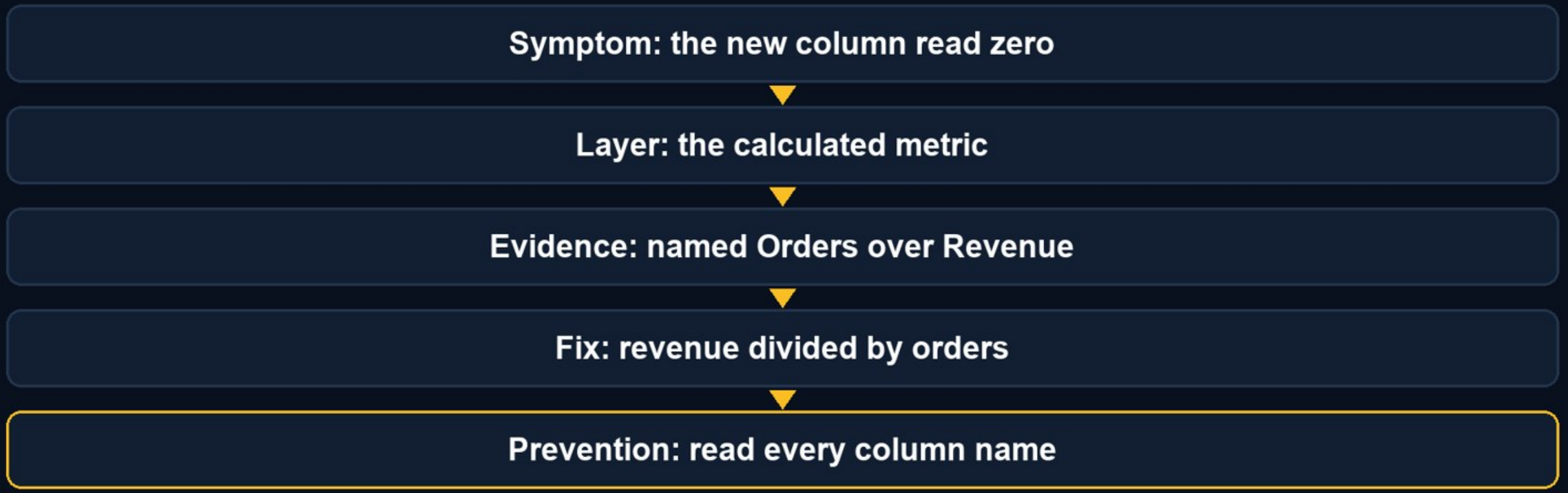
AI round: govern it, ground it, brake it

Question	Answer from the build
How do you govern AI work?	Evidence sheet; a human approves
Where does RAG fail?	The right chunk never reached it
Where does an agent stop?	Approval before anything irreversible
How do you know?	Golden set; guardrail tripped in dry run

KEY IDEA

AI may draft and a human approves. Fluent but wrong means retrieval failed. Put the human approval where the action is irreversible.

War stories: your mistakes are your evidence



KEY IDEA

A war story is a concrete problem you hit, diagnosed and fixed. Told in order, with evidence and prevention, it is strong interview material.

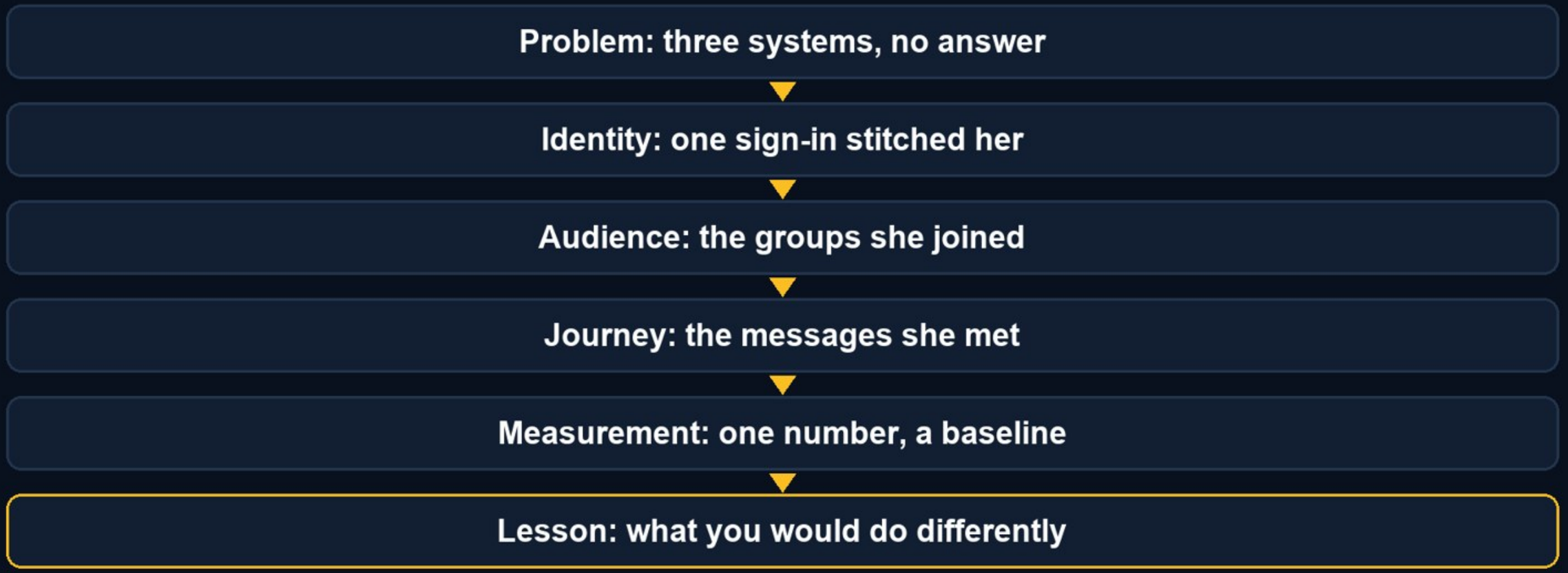
Five resume bullets, each with an artefact

- Designed a 3-schema data model with stitched identity
- Recovered a failed batch: 0 to 497 rows, error log
- Built 5 audiences, estimates read before activation
- Launched welcome and cart rescue journeys, with a holdout
- Closed the loop: a CJA fallout audience back into AJO
- Label it: a practice project, not client work

KEY IDEA

Every resume claim needs an artefact behind it: a screen, a row, a note or a sheet that someone could ask to see.

The ninety-second architecture story



KEY IDEA

One problem in a sentence, four beats through one customer, one number with its baseline, and one thing you would do differently.

Interview corner, and what we did not cover

- “I don't know, but here is how I would find out”
- Then name the docs, the sandbox test, the owner
- Not covered: advanced Data Distiller
- Not covered: the B2B edition
- Not covered: CJA admin at scale, and AEM

KEY IDEA

“I don't know, but here is how I would find out” is a strong answer. Then name exactly how you would find out.

Recap, your question, and Priya one last time

- Claim, example, trade-off, verification
- War stories and artefacts beat feature lists
- Ninety seconds: problem, four beats, one number
- Free notes, exercises and sample data in the repo
- Rewatch from episode 1, and share the playlist

KEY IDEA

Answer in claim, example, trade-off and verification. Tell failures as evidence. Priya began as an anonymous phone and ends as one known customer.